ABSTRACT

In today's digital age, memes have evolved from simple internet jokes into a powerful cultural phenomenon that shapes youth communication, behavior, and identity. This study, *Analysis of Meme Culture and Its Influence on Youth*, explores how memes function not only as entertainment but also as tools for social commentary, political expression, and emotional coping among young people. Using a mixed-methods approach, data was collected through questionnaires, interviews, and social media observations involving 20 participants aged 15–25. The findings reveal that memes are widely consumed and shared across platforms like Instagram, TikTok, Reddit, and X (formerly Twitter), often serving as a relatable medium for expressing opinions, building community, and spreading awareness about current events and social issues. While memes encourage creativity, digital literacy, and social bonding, the study also highlights challenges, such as their role in spreading misinformation and influencing perceptions in subtle but significant ways. The analysis shows that memes impact not only humor and language but also youth perspectives on politics, mental health, and cultural belonging. Overall, this project emphasizes that meme culture is a double-edged sword: it fosters expression and connectivity, yet requires critical awareness to mitigate its negative effects. The study concludes with recommendations for promoting responsible meme consumption and integrating meme culture into constructive educational and social contexts.

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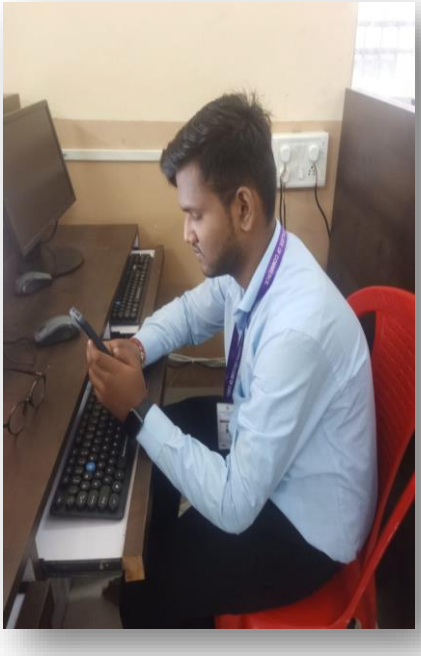

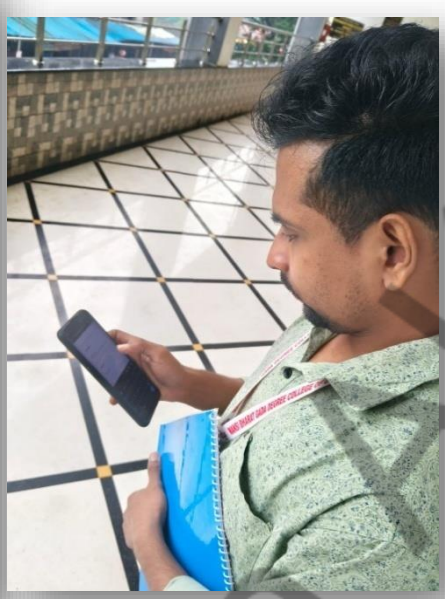

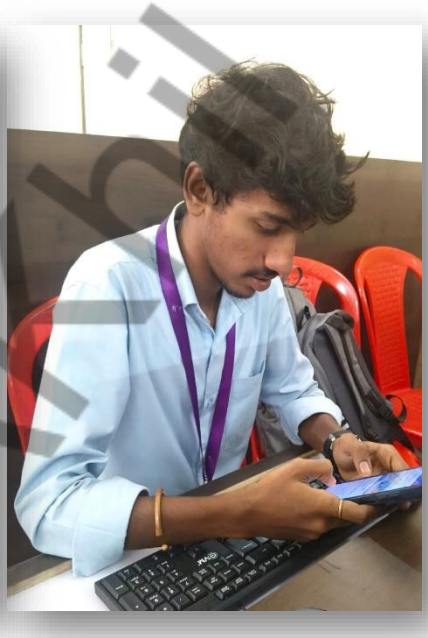

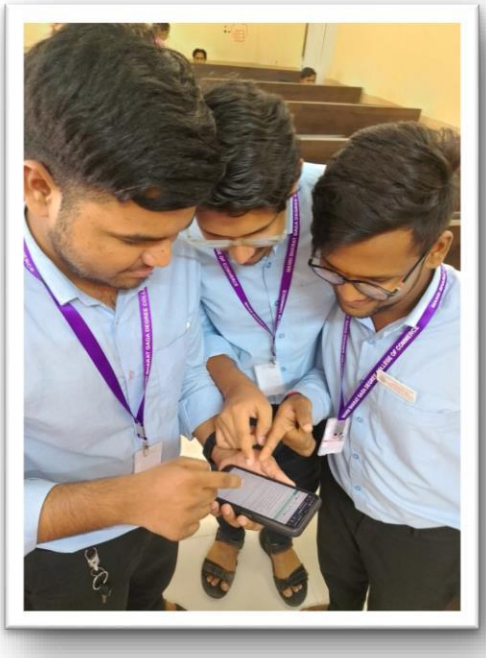

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CHAPTER 1:INTRODUCTION

In the digital age, memes have emerged as a powerful form of communication, blending humor, satire, and social commentary into easily shareable content. Originating from internet forums and rapidly spreading through social media platforms like Instagram, TikTok, Reddit, and X (formerly Twitter), memes have become a central element of online youth culture. For many young people today, memes are more than just entertainment—they serve as a way to express opinions, cope with emotions, engage with current events, and form community identities.

As this phenomenon grows, it becomes increasingly important to analyze how meme culture influences the behavior, attitudes, and perceptions of youth. From shaping political views to impacting mental health and even language, memes are now a significant force in youth socialization. This analysis seeks to explore the multifaceted effects of meme culture on young people, examining both its positive potentials and its potential drawbacks.

In recent years, meme culture has become a defining element of digital communication, especially among the youth. Memes—typically humorous images, videos, or texts—are easily shareable and often reflect current events, social trends, or personal experiences. What started as light-hearted internet jokes has evolved into a powerful cultural tool that influences the way young people think, express themselves, and engage with the world around them.

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CHAPTER 2:LITERATURE REVIEW

Since 2025:

Research on **The** Negative Role of Internet **Memes** in **Youth** Communication and **The** Correct Guidance Strategy

Z Qing - International Journal of Education and Humanities, 2025 - i-jeh.com

Since 2024:

Integrating **Memes**: Enhancing Education With Pop **Culture** A **Systematic Literature Review**

MP Rodriguez-Guillen… - 2024 International …, 2024 - ieeexplore.ieee.org

Since 2021:

Meme usage **culture** on social issues among **youth**AN Raj,

D Jayaprakash - Turkish Journal of Computer and …, 2021 - **search**.proquest.com

Since 2023:

The Impact Social Media Political Memes on Youth of Pakistan: An Analysis

S Sultana, A Batool, M Akhtar - Annals of Human and Social …, 2023 - ojs.ahss.org.pk

Since 2022:

Like, Share and Comment: Gen-Z and Political **Memes** on Social Media.

S Tandon, NV Singh, D Tripathi - Special Education, 2022 - **search**.ebscohost.com

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CHAPTER 3: METHADALOGY

3.1 Research Method:

This study adopts a **mixed-methods research design**, combining both **quantitative and qualitative** approaches to gain a comprehensive understanding of meme culture and its influence on youth

3.2 Tool Used:

1. Questionnaires-Gather data directly from youth about their meme consumption and behavior.

2. Interviews-Provide in-depth insights into youth attitudes and interpretations.

3. Software & Apps- Built-in tool for analyzing meme engagement on meme pages, Provides data on likes, shares, saves, and impressions

3.3 Sample Size:

The sample size for this study consisted of **20 participants**

3.4 Sampling Method:

a) Purposive Sampling:
Select youth who are active on social media and frequently engage with memes to gain relevant insights.

b) Quota Sampling:
Ensure representation across age groups (e.g., 13–17, 18–22, 23–25), gender, or region to reflect diversity among youth.

c) Snowball Sampling:
Start with a few meme enthusiasts, who then refer other meme-active peers, expanding the sample through their networks.

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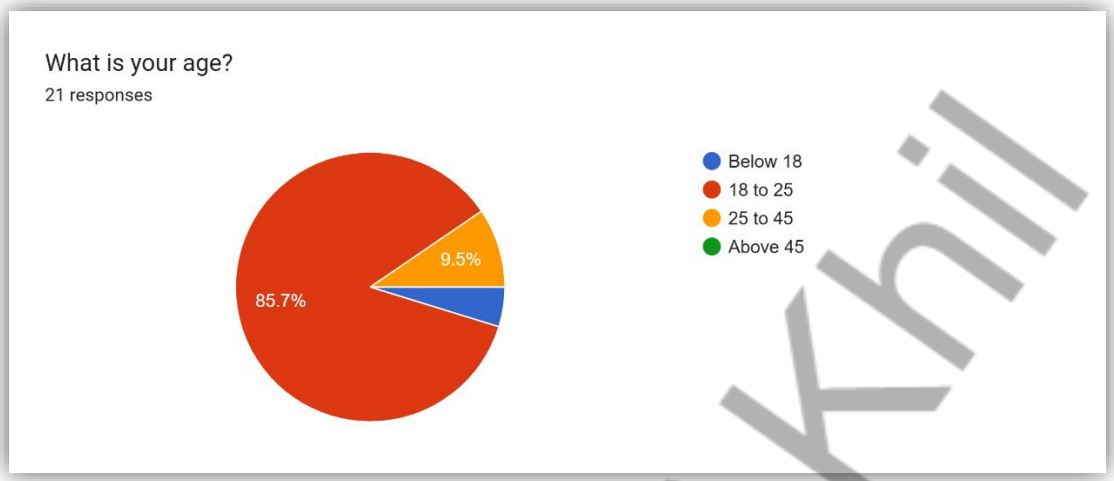
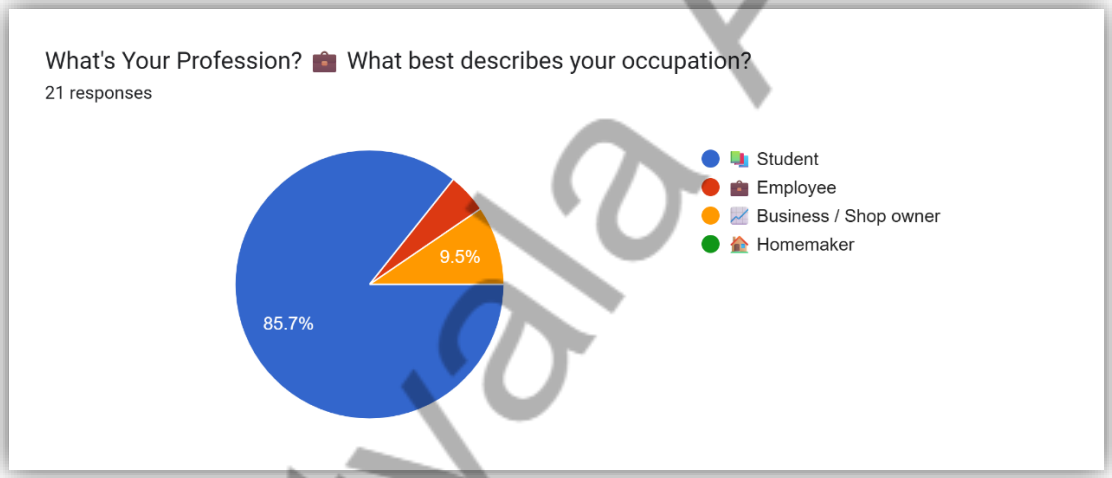
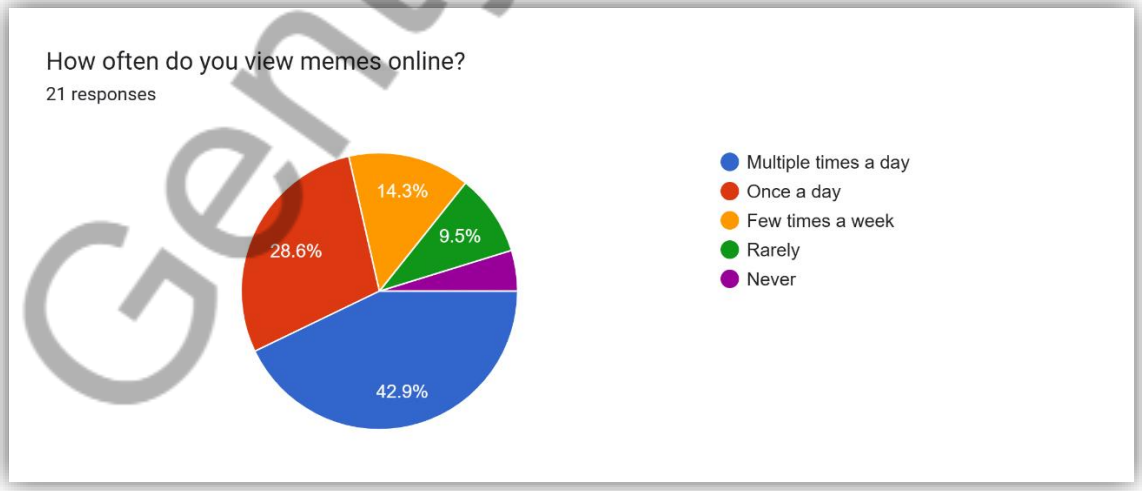
3.5 Data Analysis:







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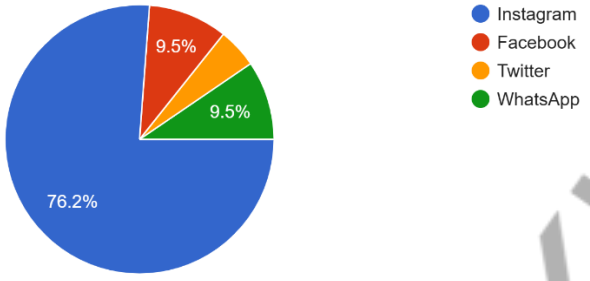
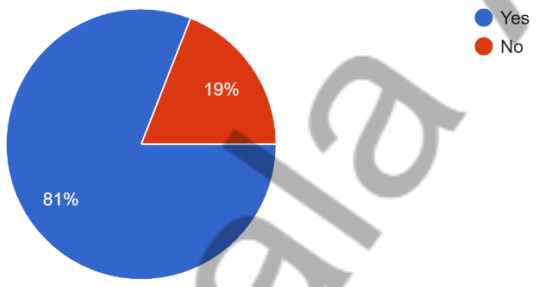
On which platforms do you mostly view or share memes? (Select all that apply)

21 responses



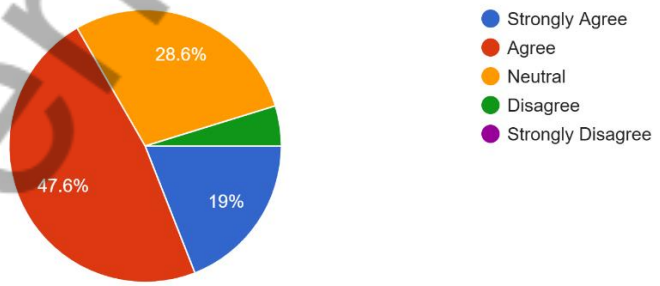
Do you actively share memes with friends or social media?

21 responses



Do you think memes influence your opinions or views on social issues?

21 responses



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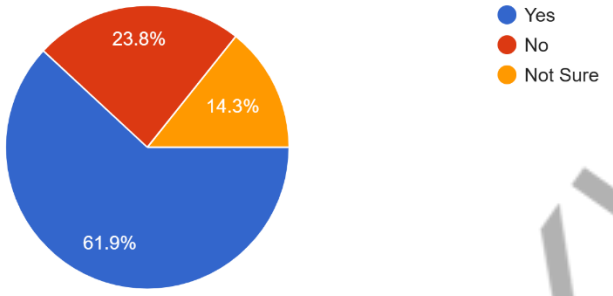
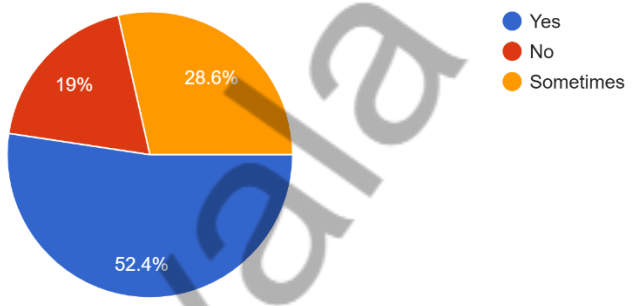
Do you believe memes help in spreading awareness about current events or social issues?

21 responses



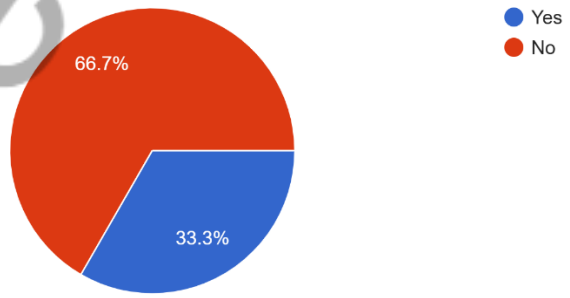
In your opinion, are memes a good source of entertainment?

21 responses



Have you ever participated in creating memes?

21 responses



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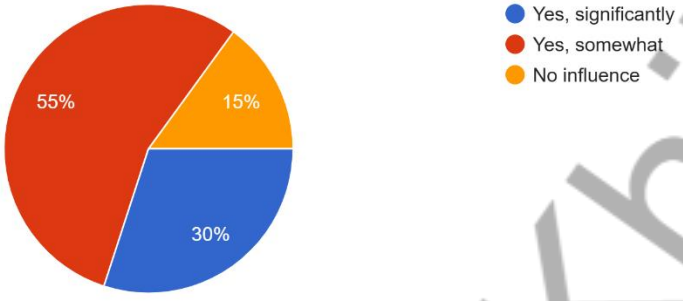
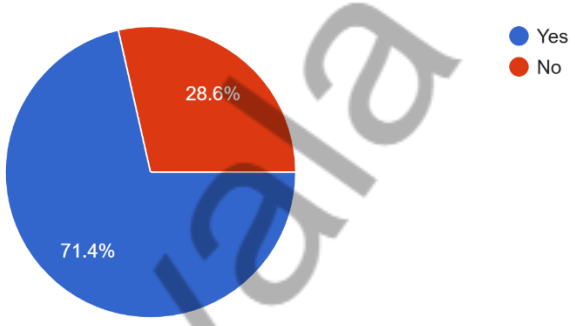
Do memes influence your sense of humor or how you express yourself online?

20 responses



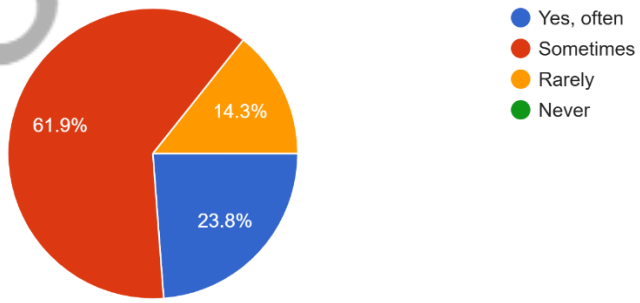
Have you ever changed your perspective on a topic after seeing a meme?

21 responses



Do you think memes contribute to spreading misinformation?

21 responses



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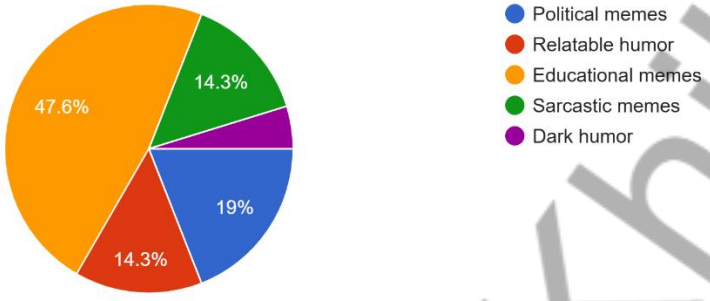
What type of memes do you enjoy the most?

21 responses



Your opinion?🤔

9 responses

🧄

Sometimes using memes is good but Sometimes it wrong also

Social media platform help of the business grow and exapand

Meme culture is an interesting phenomenon in digital media. that plays an important role in digital communication and. culture that has become a popular tool for conveying. information and ideas that spread rapidly on the internet and. social media platforms.

NA

an idea, behavior, or style that spreads by means of imitation from person to person within a culture and often carries symbolic meaning representing a particular phenomenon or theme

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Nice

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CHAPTER 4: FIELD WORK DESCRIPTION, OBERVATION AND ANALISIS

4.1 Field Work Description:

To understand the influence of meme culture on youth, I conducted a field observation over a week by engaging with various social media platforms popular among young people, such as Instagram, TikTok, Twitter, and Reddit. I observed trending memes, the frequency of sharing, and the nature of interactions among youth aged 15-24. Informal conversations and online discussions were also noted to gauge the personal and social significance of memes.

4.2 Observations :

Memes appeared as a ubiquitous form of communication and entertainment among the youth. Many memes reflected current events, popular culture, and shared experiences, Youth engaged actively by creating, modifying, and sharing memes, often using them to address serious topics like mental health, politics, and social justice in a relatable, approachable way.

4.3 Analysis:

Meme culture plays a significant role in my daily life, especially on platforms like Instagram where I frequently view and share memes with friends. I find memes to be a fun and popular form of entertainment, but also a meaningful way to spread awareness about social issues and current events. While I haven't created memes myself, I enjoy educational memes the most, as they combine humor with learning. Memes have influenced my sense of humor and how I express myself online, and in some cases, they've even changed my perspective on certain topics. However, I also recognize that memes can sometimes contribute to the spread of misinformation.

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CHAPTER 5:CONCLUSION AND RECOMMENDATION

The study concludes that meme culture has become an inseparable aspect of modern youth life, shaping the way young people communicate, learn, and express themselves in the digital space. Memes go beyond entertainment, acting as powerful tools for spreading awareness, sharing opinions, and building a sense of identity and belonging. They encourage creativity, humor, and community engagement while also influencing perspectives on serious issues such as politics, social justice, and mental health. However, the research also highlights concerns about misinformation, misinterpretation, and overdependence on memes as a source of knowledge. To maximize the positive potential of meme culture, it is recommended that digital literacy programs be introduced to help youth critically analyze content before sharing. Educators can harness memes as a creative teaching tool to make learning more interactive, while parents and mentors should guide young people to engage with online content responsibly. Social media platforms and communities should also encourage the creation and promotion of positive, inclusive, and informative memes that foster awareness and well-being. Overall, memes are cultural artifacts that, if approached thoughtfully, can serve as meaningful tools for education, awareness, and social connection, while minimizing their negative effects on society.

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